

TW Market Sep'26 Preview: Wake Me Up When September Hikes (?) - Catalysts, Flwos, and Some Ideas | GSTW

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August did a good job clearing out some of the early summer froth, setting up a much cleaner base for Taiwan equities. As we head into September, the market moves out of the summer lull and straight into the final month of 3Q26. Different from July when aggressive unwind scarred many investors and August when momentum sectors took the steering wheel, September will focus on stock picking to generate alpha.

Here is what we are watching across the desk for the month ahead:

| The Main Event: SEMICON Taiwan 2026 (Sept 2–4)

SEMICON Taiwan is the focal point of the tech calendar this month. With global semi equipment spend trending above US\$165bn (+23% YoY), institutional interest is moving past standard front-end node shrink and zeroing in on where AI compute hits physical limits:

- **The Packaging Pivot vs. The Front-End Wall:** Monolithic die scaling is running into steep thermal and wafer cost barriers, pushing performance gains into heterogeneous integration. The focus is on how foundries and OSATs manage 2.5D/3D capacity constraints while accelerating panel-level packaging (FOPLP) to bring down composite packaging costs.
- **Overcoming the Interconnect Bottleneck (Copper to Optics):** As AI cluster networking speeds push toward 1.6T and 3.2T, copper traces face undeniable power draw and signal loss limits. Adoption timelines for SiPh and CPO to see when optical engines transition from R&D into volume production will be the key focus for single stock outperformers.
- **Test Intensity & Yield Protection in Chiplets:** Disaggregating accelerators into multi-chiplet topologies compounds test complexity exponentially. Avoiding the scrap of expensive multi-die packages is driving structural demand for higher-pin-count probe interfaces, advanced test sockets, and extended burn-in cycles.
- **Yield Preservation via Cleanroom Automation:** Advanced packaging lines require significantly tighter mechanical tolerances than legacy assembly. Eliminating human contamination and cycle-time variability via automated material transport and digital twin fab management is now mandatory for high-volume ramps.

| Macro Pulse: Fed Rate Hike? vs. Taiwan Rates/FX

- **US Fed — Live September Rate Hike (~60% Odds):** Warsh's hawkish Jackson Hole pivot shifted pricing back to a **25bp hike (~14bps priced in)**, triggering a sharp front-end bear flattening (2Y yields +11bps). Our US Desk notes that the bar to hike has dropped: with July Core PCE at +0.25% MoM (3.34% YoY) and Q3 GDP tracking at +2.8%, a 20bp unrounded Core CPI print is now seen as enough to justify tightening. Tech valuations will test their duration sensitivity against this week's hard data gauntlet (ISM, ADP, Waller speech, and Friday's NFP) ahead of the blackout.
- **Taiwan CBC — Hold in Sept, Hike in Dec & Equity Implications:** Check out our full note [here](#).
 - **Policy Path:** While macro fundamentals justify tightening (>10% GDP growth, CPI >2%), the CBC is widely expected to pause at the September meeting ahead of late-November local elections, delivering a single, modest **12.5bp hike in December**.
 - **Cheap TWD Funding Fuels Tech Capex:** Wide USD-TWD rate differentials keep onshore borrowing exceptionally cheap, driving record TWD Convertible Bond (CB) issuances (~US\$6bn YTD) by tech corporates looking to finance overseas AI capex without diluting equity.
 - **CBC FX Smoothing Dampens Volatility:** The CBC continues to actively smooth USDTWD volatility both ways (near-term range 31.00–32.50), preventing aggressive hot-money outflows from destabilizing the cash equity base.
 - **No Extended Tightening Overhang:** With market pricing ~5x hikes over the next year, the CBC will likely under-deliver due to soft domestic property markets and subsidized utility rates—leaving domestic equity liquidity unconstrained.

Positioning & Fund Flows: Risk On Sentiment Needs Further Volume Support

August marked a sharp inflection in flow dynamics as institutional capital rotated back into Taiwan cash equities:

- **Foreign Investors deployed +US\$9.4bn** into cash equities over the past month (including +US\$3.7bn in the past week). Buying was concentrated in Other Tech (+US\$3.25bn) and Industrials (+US\$1.96bn), alongside steady inflows into Defensives (+US\$762mn) and Financials (+US\$625mn). Crucially, foreign selling in TSMC finally inflected to net buying (+US\$413mn over 1M / +US\$761mn 1W), breaking from the profit taking and funding short seen earlier this year.
- **Domestic Funds remained net buyers** across the board, adding **+US\$3.6bn** over the past month. The capital primarily targeted Other Tech (+US\$1.50bn), Financials (+US\$999mn), and TSMC (+US\$542mn).
- Retail picked up their margin loan balance with notional up 14% MoM, with ~10% room to its record high in early July. Retail sentiment was clearly more cautious in August after the July sell-off, and not much willingness to participate in the market. Overall market turnover declined sharply in most of August except for the last few sessions post Nvidia earnings and MSCI rebalance.

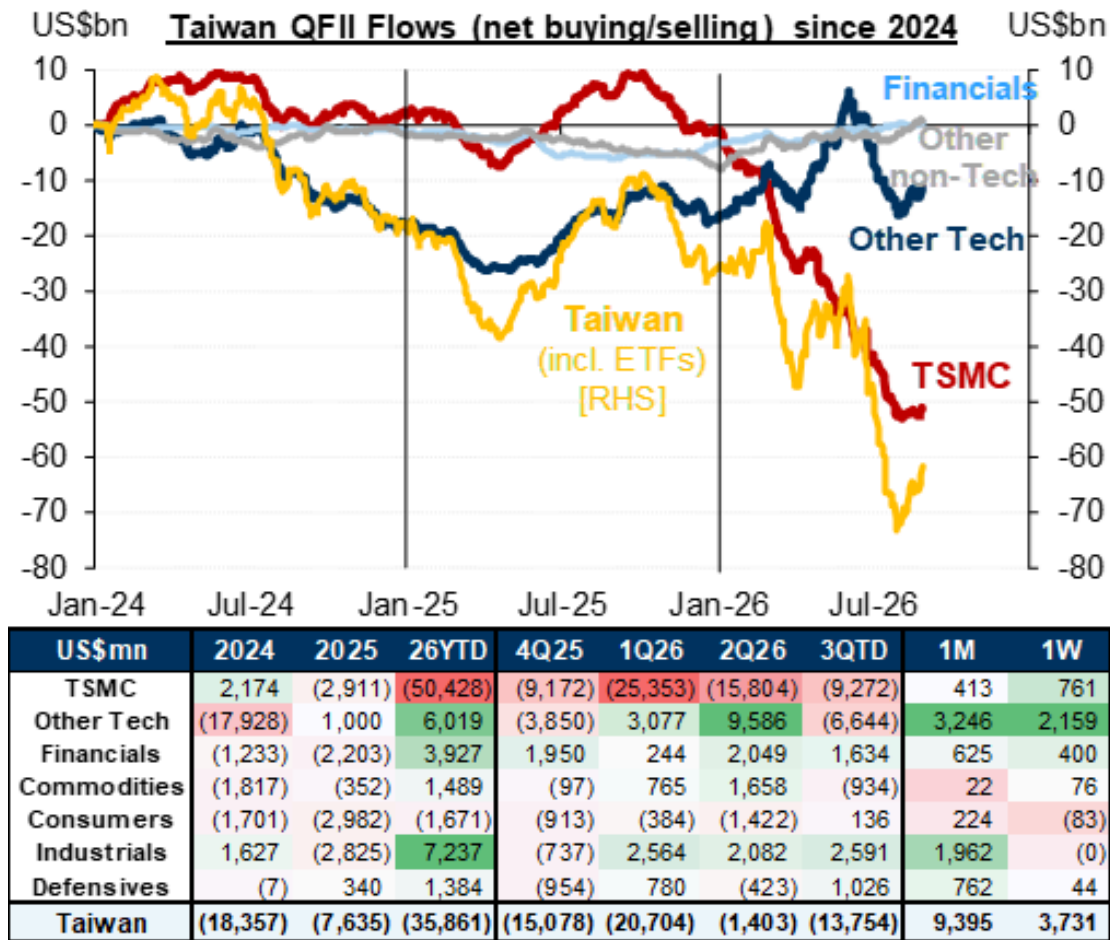


Exhibit 1. Foreigners Flow in Aug'26

Source: GS FICC and Equities. Past performance is not indicative of future results

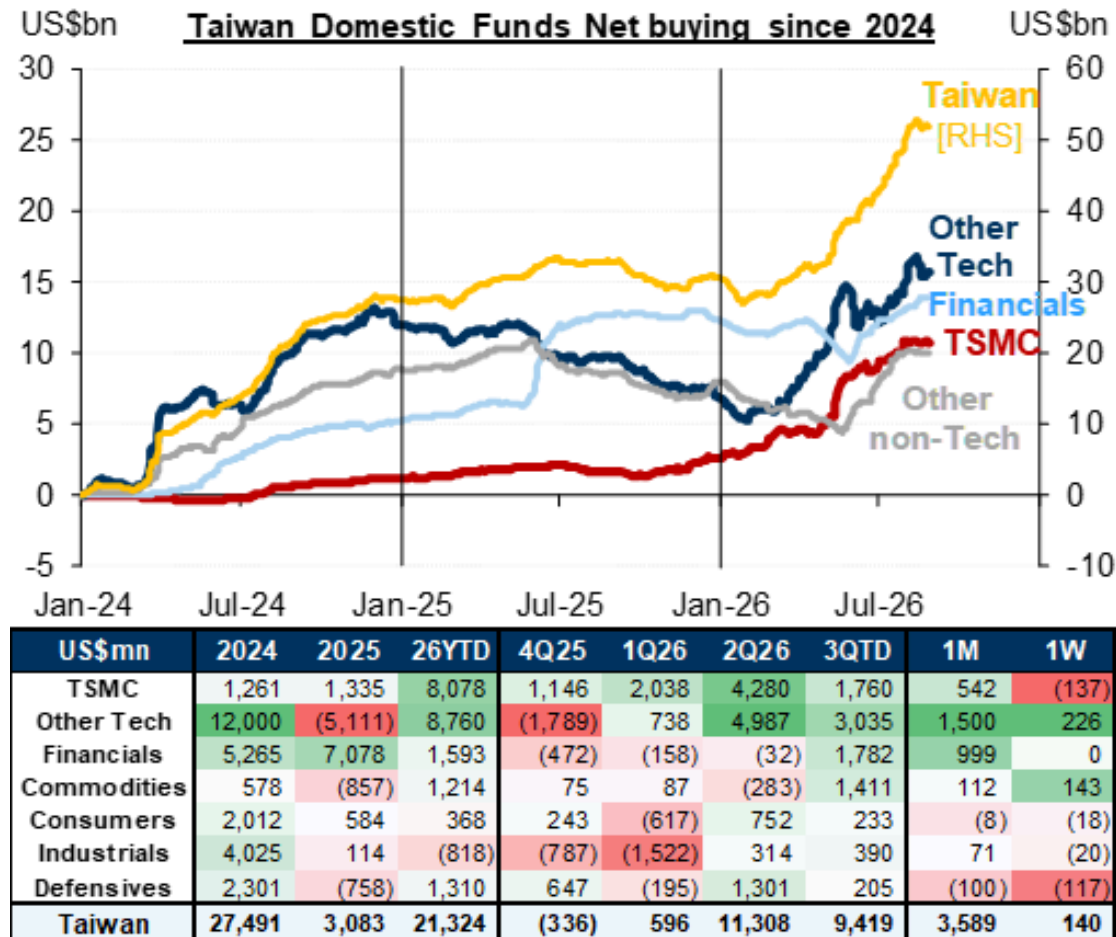


Exhibit 2. Domestic Funds Flow in Ag'26

Source: GS FICC and Equities. Past performance is not indicative of future results

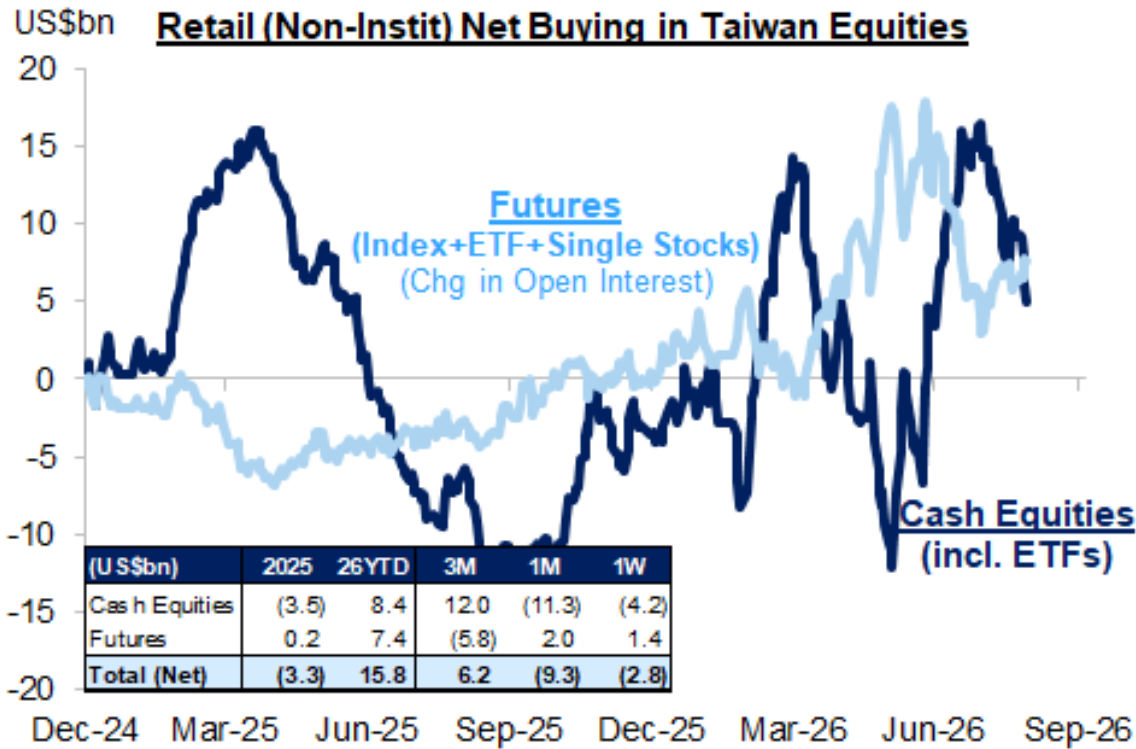


Exhibit 3. Retail Participation in Aug'26

Source: GS FICC and Equities. Past performance is not indicative of future results

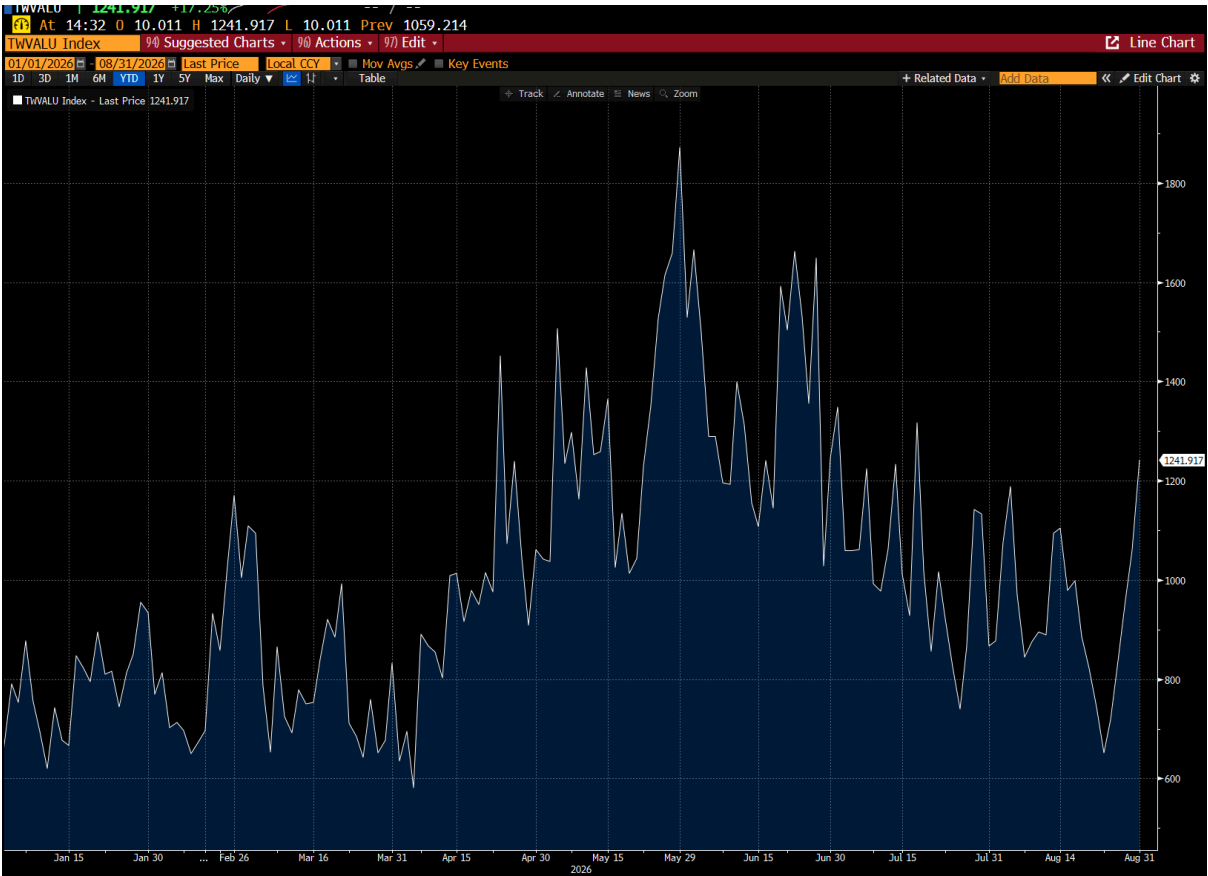


Exhibit 4. TWSE Traded Volume Historical Data YTD

Source: Bloomberg as of 8/31/2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results

Passive Liquidity Catalyst: FTSE Rebalance (Sept 18)

FTSE Russell announced the indicative results for its semi-annual Global Equity Index Series (GEIS) review (revisions open until Sept 4, implementation after market close on Friday, September 18). Taiwan is one of the largest net passive beneficiaries across APAC/EM:

- **Headline Flows & Weights:** Taiwan is expected to see **+US\$1.22bn in net passive inflows** (US\$1.70bn gross buying vs. US\$481mn gross selling). Pro forma weights rise across the board: +23bps to 17.3% in FTSE Asia, +18bps to 32.7% in FTSE EM, and +5bps to 3.28% in FTSE Global.
- **Sector Bias:** Inflows are heavily dominated by Tech Hardware & Semis (+US\$1.21bn net inflows) and Capital Goods (+US\$93mn), while Consumer Retail and Autos face minor outflows (~US\$19mn each).
- **Top 3 Inflow Names: Hon. Precision (7769 TT):** +US\$517mn (3.9 days ADVT, Addition to All Cap/World); **TUC (6274 TT):** +US\$104mn (0.4 days ADVT, Addition to All World); **Compeq (2313 TT):** +US\$61mn (0.3 days ADVT, Addition to All World). *Notable runners-up: Ta Liang (3167 TT) at +US\$51mn and Winway (6515 TT) at +US\$45mn.*
- **Top 3 Outflow Names: Inventec (2356 TT):** -US\$21mn (-0.3 days ADVT, Lower Adj. Shares); **Walsin Lihwa (1605 TT):** -US\$13mn (-0.3 days ADVT, Lower Adj. Shares); **Giant Manufacturing (9921 TT):** -US\$10mn (-0.7 days ADVT, Deletion from All World). Followed by Catcher (2474 TT) and HTC (2498 TT) at -US\$8mn each.

FTSE Taiwan (GEIS - All World/Cap)						
	All World (Large+Mid Cap)			All Cap (Large+Mid+Small)		
	Current	Proforma	Change	Current	Proforma	Change
Index Cap (US\$bn)	3,465	3,521	+2%	3,785	3,813	+1%
3M ADVT (US\$bn)	22	23	+6%	30	31	+3%
# of constituents	132	136	+4	527	536	+9
- added / deleted		7 / 3			22 / 13	
- high/lower adj shr		8 / 5			25 / 36	
	Current weight (%)	Proforma weight (%)	Change (bps)	Gross Passive Buying (US\$mn)	Gross Passive Selling (US\$mn)	Net Passive Flows (US\$mn)
Asia	17.1%	17.3%	23	20.3	(11.0)	9.3
EM (Adv. + Secondary)	32.5%	32.7%	18	628	(85)	543
World (DM + Adv. EM)	3.41%	3.47%	6	(30)	(30)	49
Global (DM + EM)	3.23%	3.28%	5	887	(271)	615
Note: Data as of Aug 21, 2026	Aggregate			1,698	(481)	1,216

Exhibit 5. FTSE Taiwan Pro Forma Passive Fund from Rebalance

Source: GS FICC and Equities

	Taiwan		Global All-Cap			
FTSE Taiwan	Weight (%)		Passive Flows (US\$m)			
GICS Sector / Industry	Current	Change (bps)	Change (pips)	Gross Buying	Gross Selling	Net Flows
Tech Hardware & Semis	85.8%	+17	+84	1,546	(337)	1,209
Capital Goods	1.4%	+8	+7	119	(27)	93
Internet/Media & Entertainment	0.1%	+1	+1	12	(0)	12
Chemicals & Other Materials	1.6%	-3	+1	16	(9)	7
Utilities	0.0%	+0	-0	0	(0)	(0)
Software & Services	0.0%	+0	-0	0	(0)	(0)
Energy	0.1%	-0	-0	0	(0)	(0)
Telecommunication Services	0.8%	-1	-0	0	(2)	(2)
Transportation	0.7%	-1	-1	0	(5)	(5)
Metals & Mining	0.2%	-0	-1	1	(8)	(7)
Insurance & Other Financials	3.2%	-5	-1	0	(9)	(9)
Consumer Staples	0.5%	-1	-1	0	(9)	(9)
Health Care	0.5%	-1	-1	1	(10)	(9)
Real Estate	0.0%	-0	-1	0	(12)	(12)
Banks	4.7%	-8	-1	1	(13)	(13)
Consumer Retail & Services	0.4%	-4	-1	2	(21)	(19)
Autos & Components	0.1%	-2	-2	0	(19)	(19)

Exhibit 6. FTSE Taiwan Pro Forma Change by Sectors

Source: GS FICC and Equities

Small-Cap Alpha Watchlist: Kaori (8996 TT) & Chipbond (6147 TT)

These are some small cap worth following that may offer structural alpha outside crowded mega-caps:

Kaori (8996 TT) — Cooling Infrastructure & SOFC Power

- **Dual Bottleneck Play:** Monopolizing Bloom Energy (BE US) SOFC Hot Boxes (2028 visibility on US data center power shortages) while moving into system-level liquid cooling (CDUs, Sidecars, RDHx) with in-house Plate Heat Exchangers (PHE). Company also announced ~NT\$6.25bn (c. US\$200mn) capex ramp across Taiwan and Thailand sites. Last but not least, liquid cooling products recovery is under way.
- **Desk View:** Following a 2Q26 platform transition trough, 2H26 earnings are inflecting sharply, with Street estimates pointing to earnings roughly doubling from ~NT\$21 in 2026 to ~NT\$39 in 2027 and ~NT\$71 in 2028.

Chipbond (6147 TT) — Silicon Photonics Ramp & UMC Partnership

- **From Price-to-Dream Ratio to Fundamental Traction:** After a sharp rally plateauing in Jun'26 that consolidated during the summer, Chipbond is now gaining real fundamental traction as commercial SiPh revenues ramp >30%+ GM.
- **The UMC (2303 TT) & TFLN Nexus:** UMC dedicated its Taiwan 8-inch Fab 8 exclusively to Thin Film Lithium Niobate (TFLN) modulators (>70% GM, >\$4,000 ASP). After securing enough backend packaging routes from UMC, Chipbond will likely see an margin-accretive testing upside (high double digits Advantest testers ordered) and >25%+ corporate GM by 2027.
- **Desk View:** Track Chipbond directly alongside UMC (2303 TT) as the market re-rates this dedicated TFLN/SiPh ecosystem.

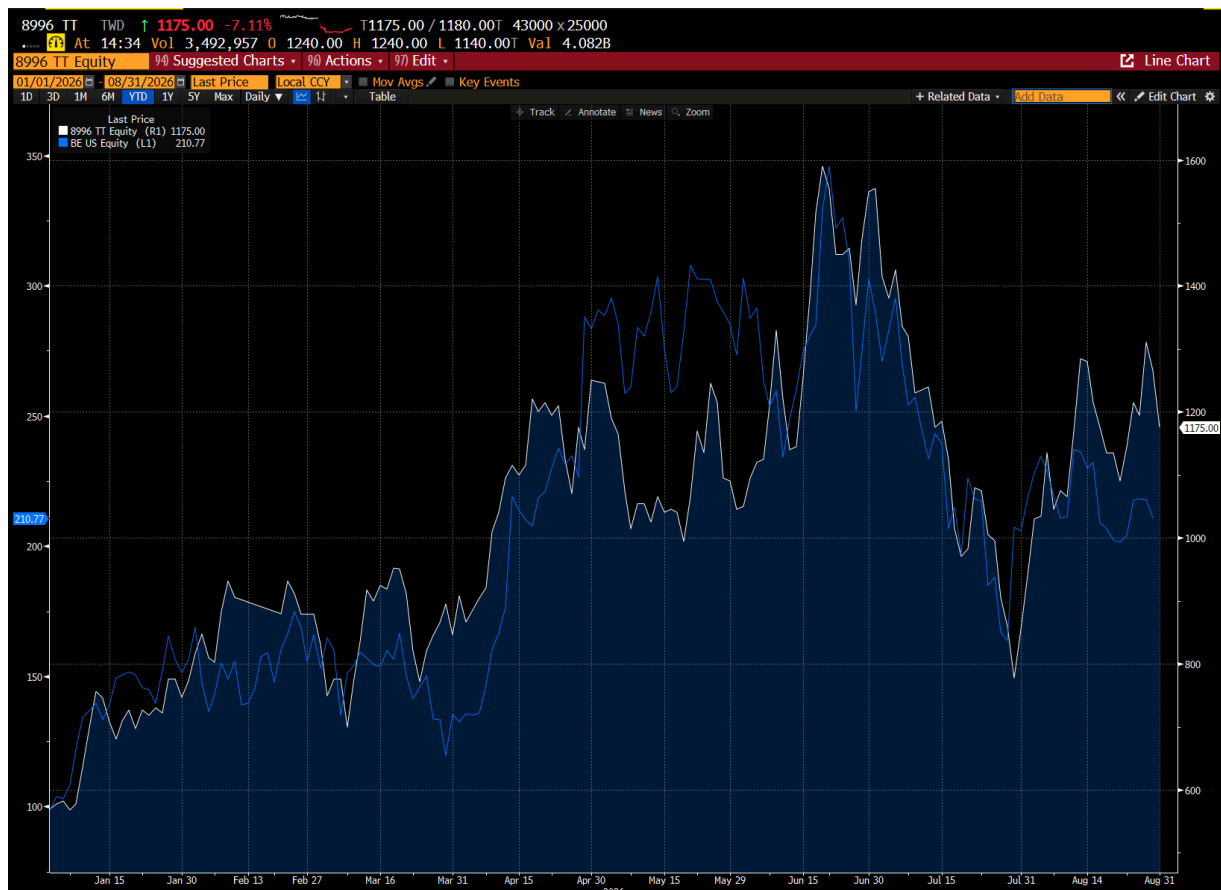


Exhibit 8. Kaori's Performance YTD vs Bloom Energy

Source: Bloomberg as of 8/31/2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results

Tactical Catch-Up Trade: MLCCs (Yageo & Other Small Cap) — The 4Q26 Price Hike Narrative

Following the 60% momentum drawdown in July, passive component multiples were reset to trough levels. With CCLs and ABF staging strong rebounds, MLCCs offer an asymmetric laggard catch-up play.

- **TrendForce Confirms 4Q26 Price Hikes:** Leading Korean maker SEMCO (005930 KS) is driving 4Q26 pricing hikes: +25% to 30% on consumer-grade X5R as channel inventories clear, and +10% to 20% on AI server-grade X6S negotiated client-by-client.
- **Fundamental Validation via Yageo (2327 TT — Buy, TP NT\$1,280):** Check out our latest note [here](#).
 - **Book-to-Bill & UTR:** Book-to-Bill jumped from 1.0+ in 1Q26 to 2.2 by end-June, with management guiding 3Q26 utilization across standard and premium lines to 90%+ (vs. 80–85% in 2Q).
 - **LTA Demand & AI Mix:** Customers are aggressively locking in LTAs for MLCCs and tantalum capacitors. Yageo's AI revenue reached 16% in 2Q26 (ahead of its full-year 15% target).
 - **Tactical Setup:** Korean price leadership gives Taiwan peers (Yageo 2327 TT) pricing cover to push through margin-accretive adjustments. At trough multiples and clean positioning, MLCCs are primed for catch-up flows.
 - **Other Small Cap Worth Following:** Walsin Tech (2492 TT), Holy Stone (3026 TT), and Prosperity Dielectrics (6173 TT)

Analysis of 2327 TT Multiples - Premium to Comps										3M	6M	1Y	2Y	5Y
Current vs 2Y Average Historical Premium							2Y Historical Premium Range			Implied @ Hist Avg				
Metric	Current	Hist Avg	Diff	# SD	3M Trend		Low	Range	High	Multiple	Price (TWD)			
Current Price							● Current ◆ Hist Avg			545.00				
1) BF P/E	-46%	-44%	-2%	-0.2	⤴		-66%	●●	15%	20.5x	567.36			
2) BF EV/EBITDA	-42%	-28%	-14%	-1.1	⤴		-61%	●●◆	23%	17.8x	685.08			
3) BF EV/EBIT	-45%	-37%	-7%	-0.6	⤴		-64%	●●◆	16%	18.8x	623.16			
4) BF EV/Rev	-46%	-24%	-22%	-1.4	⤴		-62%	●●◆	30%	7.3x	771.89			
5) LF P/BV	-66%	-54%	-12%	-1.3	⤴		-78%	●●◆	-25%	8.6x	741.70			
View All Comps Below														
Summary of Current Multiples														
	Name		2Y Corr	Mkt Cap (TWD)		BF P/E	BF EV/EBITDA	BF EV/EBIT	BF EV/Rev	LF P/BV				
11)	Yageo Corp			1.12T		19.7x	14.3x	16.5x	5.2x	6.3x				
	Current Premium to Comps Mean					-46%	-42%	-45%	-46%	-66%				
	Mean (Including 2327 TT)			1.42T		36.5x	24.9x	30.0x	9.6x	18.7x				
12)	Walsin Technology Corp		0.83	143.14B		20.5x	--	--	3.3x	2.2x				
13)	ASE Technology Holding Co Ltd		0.54	2.61T		23.3x	12.2x	20.8x	2.9x	6.6x				
14)	Kinsus Interconnect Technology		0.52	431.54B		39.5x	20.9x	31.0x	6.1x	9.7x				
15)	Unimicron Technology Corp		0.49	1.64T		29.8x	18.8x	25.9x	6.5x	12.8x				
16)	Taiwan Union Technology Corp		0.48	429.73B		22.4x	16.7x	17.2x	4.8x	17.2x				
17)	MediaTek Inc		0.46	6.30T		34.1x	27.7x	31.9x	6.2x	14.8x				
18)	Globalwafers Co Ltd		0.42	436.04B		28.0x	16.8x	30.4x	6.1x	4.5x				
19)	Nan Ya Printed Circuit Board C		0.40	794.78B		35.1x	21.4x	28.2x	9.2x	16.1x				
20)	Elite Material Co Ltd		0.38	1.97T		29.0x	21.8x	22.6x	6.9x	33.7x				
21)	Asia Vital Components Co Ltd		0.36	1.34T		24.9x	16.0x	16.8x	4.7x	24.4x				
22)	LandMark Optoelectronics Corp		0.28	359.24B		97.3x	71.6x	76.7x	38.4x	76.1x				
23)	Jentech Precision Industrial C		0.26	878.93B		54.9x	40.4x	41.8x	17.8x	37.3x				

Exhibit 8. Yageo Forward P/E vs Taiwan High Beta Names

Source: Bloomberg as of 8/31/2026

What Else To Follow?

- Unimicron Probe vs. Rotation Beneficiary Candidates:** Prosecutors searched Unimicron (3037 TT) over alleged country-of-origin mislabeling and PCN lapses on mainland China multi-layer PCB sub-assemblies; order fallout should remain contained as this impacts legacy PCBs (<5% of segment sales) while AI GPU substrates/PCBs are dual-certified. For clean exposure, consider rotating into **GCE** (2368 TT — Buy, TP NT\$1,800 | 26E/27E EPS NT\$46.54 / NT\$90.00) for AI ASIC PCB/HDI dominance (70%+ Trainium 3 share, 20–30% Google TPU in 2027 at ~11x 2027E P/E), and **NYP** (8046 TT — Buy on CL, TP NT\$2,500 | 26E/27E EPS NT\$20.68 / NT\$65.83) for unconstrained ABF spot pricing leverage with a 122% EPS CAGR. Check out our latest GCE note [here](#) and NYP note [here](#).
- PMIC & 800V HVDC Power Upcycle (Pan Jit 2481 TT & SDI Corp 2351 TT):** Local interest is picking up as global IDM price hikes (Infineon) and severe 400VDC/800VDC power rack shortages bite. Pan Jit (2481 TT) is absorbing geopolitical spillover orders from restricted Chinese suppliers with severe 400VDC component shortages stretching lead times, while SDI Corp (2351 TT) is capturing the auto-to-AI pivot as ~40 custom 800V HVDC lead frame projects ramp into volume, lifting high-margin AI revenue mix into double digits (35–40% GM vs. 18–19% corporate avg). Review my last takeaway [here](#).
- SpaceX Starmind Space AI & LEO Catalysts (Compeq 2313 TT & UMT 3491 TT):** SpaceX advancing its Starmind AI satellite deployment (Vera Rubin NVL72 in orbit) to 4Q27 to bypass ground power/cooling bottlenecks is accelerating LEO supply chain visibility. Compeq (2313 TT) holds a >80% global market share in Starlink/space-grade HDI boards, while UMT (3491 TT) has >75% of its revenue tied to high-margin (50%+) satellite RF/microwave components. Check out our latest UMT note [here](#). Other beneficiaries include related CCL and TRF/GaN suppliers such as Co-Tech (8358 TT) and Win Semi (3105 TT).

Key September 2026 Dates to Watch

- **September 2–4:** SEMICON Taiwan 2026
- **September 4:** US August Non-Farm Payrolls (NFP); FTSE Review Final Amendment Cutoff
- **September 7–9:** Taiwan August Trade & Export Data
- **September 8–10:** Goldman Sachs Communacopia + Technology Conference
- **September 9:** Apple Fall Launch Event (iPhone 18 / Apple Intelligence)
- **September 10:** Taiwan August Monthly Revenue Deadline
- **September 11:** US August Consumer Price Index (CPI)
- **September 15–16:** US FOMC Meeting
- **September 16:** TAIEX Monthly Futures & Options Expiry
- **September 17:** Taiwan CBC Central Bank Board Meeting
- **September 18:** FTSE Rebalance Implementation (Effective post-market close)
- **September 18:** Global Quadruple Witching (US Derivatives Expiry)

Please feel free to reach out to your GS representative to discuss any ideas.

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Source for all: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Company Data, Bloomberg as of 8/31/2026

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